A-A-54031
24 November 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION, STEAM

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a steam sterilization indicator strip.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization indicator strip shall provide visual indication of exposure to steam sterilization conditions by a distinctive color change on the strip. The indicator area shall change color when used as directed inside a surgical pack and subjected to steam at 250° F for 15 minutes or at 270° F for 3 minutes.

Other than the color change, the entire indicator shall be totally unaffected by autoclaving conditions. Smudging, flaking, or any form of physical damage to the indicator shall be unacceptable. The color change and original color must be distinctive enough for the end-user to easily differentiate between gas or steam sterilization indicators.

Indicator strips shall not be less than 6-1/2 inches long and 1/2 inch wide. Each strip shall be imprinted with instructions for use and for positive determination of completed exposures.

Workmanship. The steam sterilization indicator shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing two hundred and fifty (250) indicators, with instruction for use, as specified, constitutes one unit.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of 250 indicators, as specified in this description.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to contents and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-00-079-7039

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1932

Location: CID/INDICATOR/H1B-33

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